



OnePlus Nord

Exploring the Indian roots of the midrange device from OnePlus, and the OnePlus R6D team here. <https://digit.in/aug20-65>



OnePlus Buds

Along with the OnePlus Nord, a new pair of wireless earbuds were also launched by the company. <https://digit.in/aug20-66>

PTron Tangent Evo

Acceptable performance for the price

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Tron launched a new budget wireless neckband-style earphone, the PTron

Tangent Evo, recently. Priced extremely conservatively at ₹849, the wireless in-ears come equipped with Bluetooth 5.0 and music+call controls. So, let's see how these inexpensive Bluetooth earphones fared in our review.

Build and design

The PTron Tangent Evo earphones are predominantly made up of plastic, however, the earbuds do feature metal housings which look striking.

The rest of the build, however, feels plasticky and cheap to the touch, as you'd expect from budget wireless earphones. The plastic neckband is flexible enough that you can store the earphones in tiny bags and the modules are not too bulky as well. The right module houses the three physical buttons (Power, + and -), and the micro-USB charging port, which is tucked under a tiny flap. The buttons are tactile and have a satisfying click sound.

The neckband also features two cable adjusters that allow you to reel back the wires if needed. Speaking of the wires, they're thin, round cables that don't feel too robust, so you should strive to use them carefully.

Lastly, the buds are tiny and ergonomic. The back of each bud comes with a magnetic housing that causes the earbuds to attach to one another when lying idle. The magnets are pretty strong too. The earbuds also come equipped with comfortable silicone ear gels or ear fins, that enhances the fit by a lot. The earphones are comfortable enough to be worn for hours without any ear fatigue and the silicone tips and ear gels ensure a snug fit even during walking and jogging.

Features

The PTron Tangent Evo Bluetooth earphones don't have a ton of features



to offer. They come with the bare minimum features such as Bluetooth 5.0, 33 feet Bluetooth range (without obstacles), music playback and call controls, an inbuilt microphone and an 8-hour long battery life. There's also basic voice prompts to tell users about the connection status, and battery level.

The PTron Tangent Evo also comes with micro-USB charging, which is standard at this price. However, it does miss out on an IP Rating, which some budget audio products do offer.

Performance

Coming to the sound quality, it's definitely got a characteristic dark sound profile with punchy and muddled bass. It's a decent sound profile which will not blow your mind away in any way, but at the price, it is acceptable.

The bass response is definitely punchy and energetic, however, it is quite muddy. Lows and bass beats sound distorted in some tracks. In *Mindstreet* by *Motherjane*, the bass guitar sounded quite muddled. This caused the vocals to get slightly masked by the overwhelming murkiness of the bass.

The vocals, by themselves, are quite clear and male vocals especially, sound clear and sharp. Female vocals do suf-

fer from some sibilance. The highs are quite tinny, especially at higher volume levels. However, the bass and lows definitely call most of the shots on these earphones. The passive isolation on these earphones is quite good, primarily due to the snug fit of the buds.

The Bluetooth connectivity is pretty good, the connection is stable and there are no lags and skips in audio. However, sometimes, the earphones did disconnect from the phone for no reason whatsoever. We had to go to the Bluetooth menu and reconnect the earphones manually.

The microphone, again, is subpar and the receiver at the other end stated that our voice sounded slightly muffled and seemed to be coming from far away. The battery life, on the other hand, is pretty decent. The company claim is about

8 hours, but in our tests we managed to squeeze out about 7 hours of juice from the earphones, which isn't bad for wireless in-ears.

Bottomline

Priced at ₹849, the earphones are definitely a purchase that is easy on the wallet. While you do get a comfortable and snug fit, Bluetooth 5.0 connectivity, and music and call controls on the PTron Tangent Evo earphones, some issues such as muddy bass, subpar microphone performance, lack of voice assistant support, and no IP rating deter us from whole-heartedly recommending these earphones. Still, if you only use your earphones to casually listen to music and don't care much about the features and the microphone, the earphones could be a half-decent affordable pick.

—Dhriti Datta

SPECIFICATIONS

EARPHONE TYPE: In-ear, wireless | STYLE: neckband | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.0 | BATTERY LIFE: 8 hours | BATTERY CAPACITY: 160mAh | CHARGING TIME: 3 hours | DRIVER SIZE: 10mm | BLUETOOTH TRANSMISSION RANGE: 10m (33 feet) | WEIGHT: 90g

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